

Trends and Phenomena

潮流与现象探讨

Date: 2026-05-24 | Level: A1-A2

English Class Course Material

Learning Goals

学习目标

- Understand what trends are and how they work

理解什么是潮流以及它们如何运作

- Learn vocabulary about minimalism, maximalism, and nostalgia

学习极简主义、极繁主义和怀旧相关词汇

- Discuss the 'Looks Maxing' phenomenon and halo effect

讨论'颜值最大化'现象和光环效应

- Express opinions about social trends in English

用英语表达对社会潮流的看法

- Practice comparing different lifestyle choices

练习比较不同的生活方式选择

Warm-up Questions

课前讨论

1. What trends are popular right now in China?

现在中国流行什么潮流？

2. Do you prefer simple or fancy designs? Why?

你更喜欢简约还是华丽的设计？为什么？

3. Have you noticed any old styles coming back?

你有没有注意到一些旧风格又回来了？

4. Do you think appearance affects success?

你觉得外貌会影响成功吗？

Key Vocabulary

核心词汇

Word	Pron.	POS	Chinese	Example
trend	/trend/	n.	潮流, 趋势	That style is a big trend now. Trends change every year.
vintage	/'vɪntɪdʒ/	adj.	复古的, 老式的	She loves vintage clothes. Vintage furniture is very popular.
minimalism	/'mɪnəməlɪzəm/	n.	极简主义	Minimalism means less is more. Her home shows minimalism.
maximalism	/'mæksəməlɪzəm/	n.	极繁主义	Maximalism loves bold colors. Maximalism is the opposite of minimalism.
utility	/ju:'tɪləti/	n.	实用性, 效用	This bag has great utility. Utility is more important than looks.
live stream	/lɪv stri:m/	n.	直播	She watches live streams every night. Live streaming is a huge trend.

futurism	/'fju:tʃəɾɪzəm/	n.	未来主义	Futurism imagines tomorrow's world. The design has a futurism style.
individuality	/ˌɪndəˌvɪdʒuˈæləti/	n.	个性, 独特性	Express your individuality. Fashion shows individuality.
halo effect	/'heɪloo ɪ'fekt/	n.	光环效应	The halo effect changes how we see people. Good looks create a halo effect.
nostalgia	/nɒ'stældʒə/	n.	怀旧, 乡愁	Nostalgia makes us miss the past. Old songs bring nostalgia.
cringe	/krɪndʒ/	v./adj.	尴尬, 让人难为情	That video is so cringe. I cringe when I see old photos.
looks maxing	/lʊks 'mæksɪŋ/	n.	颜值最大化	Looks maxing is a big internet trend. Some people take looks maxing too far.
golden age	/'gouldən eɪdʒ/	n.	黄金时代	The 1990s were a golden age of music. Every era thinks it was the golden age.
less is more	/les ɪz mɔːr/	phrase	少即是多	Minimalism believes less is more. In design, sometimes less is more.
aesthetic	/iːs'θetɪk/	n./adj.	美学, 审美的	I like her aesthetic. The aesthetic of this room is very clean.
phenomenon	/fə'nɒmɪnən/	n.	现象	Social media is a modern phenomenon. That phenomenon is hard to explain.

Additional Example Sentences

扩展例句

trend /trend/ n.

潮流, 趋势

Fashion trends come and go quickly. | Following every trend can be expensive.

时尚潮流来去匆匆。| 追随每个潮流可能很花钱。

vintage /'vɪntɪdʒ/ adj.

复古的, 老式的

Vintage shops are very popular with young people. | He collects vintage watches.

复古店在年轻人中很受欢迎。| 他收藏老式手表。

minimalism /'mɪnəməlɪzəm/ n.

极简主义

Minimalism helps you focus on what matters. | She adopted minimalism and gave away half her things.

极简主义帮你专注于重要的事。| 她接受极简主义, 送掉了一半东西。

maximalism /'mæksəməlɪzəm/ n.

极繁主义

Maximalism is about more is more. | The room was decorated in maximalism style.

极繁主义就是多多益善。| 房间按极繁主义风格装饰。

utility /juː'tɪləti/ n.

实用性, 效用

The utility of this tool is amazing. | We value utility over appearance.

这个工具的实用性惊人。| 我们重视实用胜过外观。

live stream /lɪv stri:m/ n.

直播

Many people make money from live streams. | She started a live stream to sell products.

很多人靠直播赚钱。| 她开直播卖产品。

futurism /'fju:tʃəɾɪzəm/ n.

未来主义

Futurism in art started in the early 1900s. | The building has a futurism look.

未来主义艺术始于20世纪初。| 这栋建筑有未来主义外观。

individuality /ˌɪndəˌvɪdʒuˈæləti/ n.

个性，独特性

School uniforms can limit individuality. | She expresses individuality through her clothes.

校服可能限制个性。| 她通过服装表达个性。

halo effect /ˈheɪləʊ ɪˈfekt/ n.

光环效应

The halo effect means one good trait makes you think everything is good. | Attractive people benefit from the halo effect.

光环效应指一个好的特质让你觉得一切都好。| 有魅力的人受益于光环效应。

nostalgia /nəˈstældʒə/ n.

怀旧，乡愁

Nostalgia is when you miss the past. | The movie filled me with nostalgia.

怀旧就是你想念过去。| 这部电影让我充满怀旧之情。

cringe /krɪndʒ/ v./adj.

尴尬，让人难为情

I cringe at my old social media posts. | That joke was so cringe.

我看到以前的社交媒体帖子就尴尬。| 那个笑话太尴尬了。

looks maxing /lʊks ˈmæksɪŋ/ n.

颜值最大化

Looks maxing means trying to look as good as possible. | The looks maxing trend started online.

颜值最大化就是尽量让自己好看。| 颜值最大化潮流起源于网络。

golden age /ˈɡəʊldən eɪdʒ/ n.

黄金时代

People often think the past was a golden age. | Was the 1980s the golden age of pop music?

人们常觉得过去是黄金时代。| 1980年代是流行音乐的黄金时代吗？

less is more /les ɪz mɔːr/ phrase

少即是多

In cooking, sometimes less is more. | The designer believes less is more.

烹饪中有时少即是多。| 这位设计师信奉少即是多。

aesthetic /iːsˈθetɪk/ n./adj.

美学，审美的

Everyone has their own aesthetic. | The aesthetic of this cafe is very cozy.

每个人都有自己的审美。| 这家咖啡馆的美学很温馨。

phenomenon /fəˈnɒmɪnən/ n.

现象

The phenomenon of online shopping changed everything. | It's a strange phenomenon.

网购现象改变了一切。| 这是一个奇怪的现象。

Useful Expressions

实用表达

Describing trends and changes

描述潮流与变化

A:

Have you noticed that everyone is wearing vintage clothes lately?
你有没有注意到最近大家都在穿复古衣服？

B:

Yes, it's a huge trend right now. Nostalgia is very popular.
是的，这是现在的大潮流。怀旧很流行。

A:

Trends come and go so fast these days.
现在的潮流来去太快了。

B:

That's because social media makes trends spread quickly.
因为社交媒体让潮流传播得很快。

Comparing styles (minimalism vs maximalism)

比较风格（极简主义 vs 极繁主义）

A:

Do you prefer minimalism or maximalism?
你更喜欢极简主义还是极繁主义？

B:

I like minimalism. Less is more, right?
我喜欢极简主义。少即是多，对吧？

A:

But maximalism is so fun! More colors, more patterns!
但极繁主义很有趣！更多颜色，更多图案！

B:

I guess it depends on your aesthetic. Both have their charm.
我想这取决于你的审美。两者各有魅力。

Expressing opinions about social phenomena

对社会现象表达看法

A:

What do you think about the looks maxing trend?
你怎么看颜值最大化这个潮流？

B:

I think it's a bit cringe. Appearance isn't everything.
我觉得有点尴尬。外貌不是一切。

A:

But the halo effect shows that looks do matter in society.
但光环效应表明外貌在社会中确实重要。

B:

That's true, but we shouldn't let it control our lives.
没错，但我们不该让它控制我们的生活。

Talking about nostalgia and the past

谈论怀旧与过去

A:

Do you ever feel nostalgia for the past?
你有没有怀念过去？

B:

All the time! I miss the golden age of the internet.
经常！我怀念互联网的黄金时代。

A:

Was it really better, or does nostalgia make it seem better?
真的更好吗，还是怀旧让它看起来更好？

B:

Good point. Nostalgia can make us forget the bad parts.
说得好。怀旧会让我们忘记不好的部分。

Dialogue / Reading

对话与阅读

Scene 1: What Are Trends? — Teacher explains with a graph metaphor

场景1：什么是潮流？ — 老师用图表比喻解释

Teacher:

Today we're going to talk about trends and phenomena. Does anyone know what a trend is?
今天我们要聊聊潮流和现象。有人知道什么是潮流吗？

Student A:

Like... what's popular right now?
就是……现在流行的东西？

Teacher:

Yes! Trends are like... this is time, this is how popular something is.
对！潮流就像……这是时间，这是某样东西有多流行。

Teacher:

Imagine a graph. It goes up, up, up, and then... it goes down. That's a trend.

想象一张图表。它往上、往上、往上，然后……往下降。这就是潮流。

Student B:

So everything that becomes popular is a trend?

所以所有流行的东西都是潮流？

Teacher:

Not exactly. A trend is when many people do the same thing for a period of time. It's a phenomenon.

不完全是。潮流是很多人在同一时期做同样的事。这是一种现象。

Student C:

Can you give us an example?

能举个例子吗？

Teacher:

Sure. Live streaming is a trend. Vintage fashion is a trend. Even the way we talk can be a trend.

当然。直播是一种潮流。复古时尚是一种潮流。甚至我们说话的方式也可以是潮流。

Teacher:

The interesting thing is: trends always come back. What was old becomes new again.

有趣的是：潮流总会回来。旧的变成新的。

Scene 2: Minimalism vs Maximalism — Comparing design styles

场景2：极简主义 vs 极繁主义 — 比较设计风格

Teacher:

Now let's talk about two big design trends: minimalism and maximalism.

现在我们来聊聊两个大设计潮流：极简主义和极繁主义。

Teacher:

Before maybe lots of colors everywhere. But now everything is like gray, white, black.

以前可能到处都是颜色。但现在一切都是灰色、白色、黑色。

Student A:

That's minimalism, right? Less is more?

那就是极简主义，对吧？少即是多？

Teacher:

Exactly. Minimalism says: fewer things, simpler design, more utility.

没错。极简主义说：更少的东西，更简单的设计，更注重实用性。

Student B:

What about maximalism?

那极繁主义呢？

Teacher:

Maximalism is the opposite. More colors, more patterns, more everything! It's about individuality.

极繁主义正好相反。更多颜色，更多图案，更多一切！它强调个性。

Student C:

Which one is better?

哪个更好？

Teacher:

There's no right answer. It depends on your aesthetic. Some people like clean and simple, others like bold and rich.

没有标准答案。取决于你的审美。有人喜欢干净简约，有人喜欢大胆丰富。

Teacher:

Right now, minimalism is the bigger trend. But maximalism is coming back.

目前极简主义是更大的潮流。但极繁主义正在回归。

Scene 3: Looks Maxing — Internet culture and appearance

场景3：颜值最大化 — 网络文化与外貌

Teacher:

Now, has anyone heard of 'looks maxing'?

有人听说过'颜值最大化'吗？

Student A:

Is it about trying to look as good as possible?

是关于尽量让自己好看吗？

Teacher:

Looks maxing means this idea that the only thing in life that matters is how you look.

颜值最大化的意思是生活中唯一重要的就是你的外貌。

Student B:

That sounds a bit extreme...

听起来有点极端……

Teacher:

It is. It started as an internet phenomenon. Some people take it very seriously.

确实。它起源于一种网络现象。有些人非常认真对待。

Student C:

Is it cringe?

尴尬吗？

Teacher:

Some people think so. But it also shows how much pressure society puts on appearance.

有人这么觉得。但它也说明了社会对外貌的压力有多大。

Teacher:

The problem is when people think looks are everything. That's not healthy.

问题在于当人们觉得外貌就是一切。那不健康。

Student A:

So we should care about appearance, but not too much?

所以我们该在乎外貌，但不要太过？

Teacher:

Exactly. Take care of yourself, but remember: your value is not just your looks.

没错。照顾好自己，但记住：你的价值不只是外貌。

Scene 4: Halo Effect — How appearance affects perception

场景4：光环效应 — 外貌如何影响认知

Teacher:

Let's talk about something related: the halo effect.

我们来聊聊一个相关的概念：光环效应。

Student A:

What's the halo effect?

什么是光环效应？

Teacher:

The halo effect is when you see one good thing about a person and assume everything about them is good.

光环效应就是当你看到一个人好的方面，就假设他一切都好。

Teacher:

For example, if someone is very attractive, people often think they are also smart and kind.

比如，如果一个人很有魅力，人们常认为他们也很聪明、很善良。

Student B:

Is that fair?

这公平吗？

Teacher:

Not really. It's a bias. Our brain takes shortcuts.

不太公平。这是一种偏见。我们的大脑会走捷径。

Student C:

So good-looking people have an advantage?

所以好看的人有优势？

Teacher:

In many situations, yes. Studies show the halo effect affects hiring, salaries, and even court decisions.

在很多情况下是的。研究表明光环效应影响招聘、薪资，甚至法庭判决。

Teacher:

But being aware of it is the first step to fighting this bias.

但意识到它是对抗这种偏见的第一步。

Scene 5: Mouse Utopia Experiment — Behavioral science

场景5：老鼠乌托邦实验 — 行为科学

Teacher:

Now let's look at an interesting experiment. It's called the Mouse Utopia experiment.

现在我们看一个有趣的实验。叫老鼠乌托邦实验。

Student A:

Mouse Utopia? What's that?

老鼠乌托邦？那是什么？

Teacher:

A scientist gave mice everything they needed: food, water, safety. No predators, no problems.

一位科学家给了老鼠它们需要的一切：食物、水、安全。没有天敌，没有问题。

Student B:

Sounds like paradise. What happened?

听起来像天堂。然后呢？

Teacher:

At first, the population grew. But then... strange things happened.

一开始，种群增长。但后来……奇怪的事情发生了。

Teacher:

Some mice stopped socializing. Some became aggressive. Some just did nothing all day.

有些老鼠不再社交。有些变得有攻击性。有些整天什么都不做。

Student C:

Why? They had everything!

为什么？它们什么都有！

Teacher:

That's the question. Without challenges, without purpose, behavior changes. It's a phenomenon.

这就是问题所在。没有挑战，没有目标，行为就会改变。这是一种现象。

Teacher:

Nostalgia is when you miss the past. It's a strong feeling. Some people think the past was a golden age.

怀旧就是你想念过去。这是一种强烈的感受。有些人觉得过去是黄金时代。

Teacher:

This experiment makes us think: are we like those mice? Do we need challenges to be healthy?

这个实验让我们思考：我们像那些老鼠吗？我们需要挑战才能健康吗？

Student A:

That's deep. I never thought about it that way.

这很深刻。我从未这样想过。

Guided Practice

引导练习

Exercise 1: Fill in the blanks

练习1：填空

Complete the sentences with the correct word from the vocabulary list.

1. A _____ is when many people do the same thing for a period of time (). _____
2. _____ means fewer things and simpler design (). _____
3. The _____ effect means one good trait makes you think everything is good ().

4. _____ is when you miss the past (). _____

5. Looks _____ means the idea that appearance is the most important thing ().

Exercise 2: True or False

练习2：判断对错

Write T (True) or F (False) for each statement.

1. Minimalism and maximalism are the same design style. () _____

2. The halo effect means attractive people are assumed to have other good qualities. () _____

3. Nostalgia is when you are excited about the future. () _____

4. Trends always stay the same and never change. () _____

5. The Mouse Utopia experiment showed that too much comfort can cause problems. () _____

Exercise 3: Match the term to its definition

练习3：匹配术语与定义

Match each term to its correct definition.

A. Minimalism B. Halo effect C. Nostalgia D. Looks maxing E. Phenomenon

1. A design style that says less is more → _____

2. When one good trait makes you assume everything is good → _____

3. A strong feeling of missing the past → _____

4. The idea that appearance is the only thing that matters → _____

5. An observable event or fact that can be studied → _____

Speaking Task

口语任务

Task 1: Describe a trend you've noticed recently

任务1：描述你最近注意到的潮流

Tell your partner about a trend you have noticed. Answer these questions:

- What is the trend?
- When did it start?
- Why do you think it became popular?
- Do you like it or not? Why?

Task 2: Debate — Is minimalism or maximalism better for modern life?

任务2：辩论 — 极简主义还是极繁主义更适合现代生活？

Debate with your partner. One person supports minimalism, the other supports maximalism.

- Give at least 2 reasons for your side
- Respond to your partner's points
- Use vocabulary: minimalism, maximalism, utility, aesthetic, less is more, individuality

► Useful phrases: I believe... because... / That's a good point, but... / In my opinion...

Task 3: Role-play — Interview about a social phenomenon

任务3：角色扮演 — 关于社会现象的采访

Student A: You are a journalist. Interview your partner about a social phenomenon.

Student B: You are an expert. Answer the journalist's questions about the phenomenon.

► Choose one phenomenon: looks maxing, halo effect, nostalgia trend, or live streaming culture

► Useful phrases: Can you explain...? / What's your opinion on...? / The interesting thing is...

Review

复盘总结

Key Takeaways

核心要点

- A trend is when many people do the same thing for a period of time
潮流是很多人在同一时期做同样的事
- Minimalism says less is more; maximalism says more is more
极简主义说少即是多；极繁主义说多多益善
- The halo effect makes us assume good-looking people have other good qualities
光环效应让我们认为好看的人也有其他优点
- Nostalgia is a strong feeling of missing the past, sometimes called a golden age
怀旧是强烈地想念过去，有时被称为黄金时代
- Social phenomena like looks maxing show how appearance affects modern culture
颜值最大化等社会现象展示了外貌如何影响现代文化

Self-Check

自我检测

1. Can you explain the difference between minimalism and maximalism?

你能解释极简主义和极繁主义的区别吗？

2. What is the halo effect and how does it affect our judgment?

什么是光环效应，它如何影响我们的判断？

3. Can you describe one social phenomenon from this lesson in English?

你能用英语描述本课的一个社会现象吗？

Homework

课后练习

Writing

写作练习

Write a short paragraph (5-8 sentences) about a trend you like or dislike.

► Use at least 5 vocabulary words from this lesson.

► Example structure: The trend I want to talk about is... / It started when... / I like/dislike it because... / In my opinion... / This trend shows that...

Vocabulary Review

词汇复习

Review all vocabulary words. Write a sentence for each of these words:

- trend
- minimalism
- nostalgia
- halo effect
- phenomenon
- aesthetic

Listening Practice

听力练习

Listen to the class recording again. Write down 3 new expressions you learned.

Answer Key (Exercises 1-3)

练习答案

Exercise 1: 1. trend 2. Minimalism 3. halo 4. Nostalgia 5. maxing

Exercise 2: 1. F 2. T 3. F 4. F 5. T

Exercise 3: 1-A 2-B 3-C 4-D 5-E